Eli's Reading Practice

Level 2 (about 4.0 grade level) • Words from Vowel Sounds oo
Read each passage carefully, then answer the questions. Use the passage to find evidence for your answers.

The Crooked Booth

(fiction)

Every fall, our town holds a fair to celebrate the harvest. This year, my cousin Ava and I offered to build a booth for the bookstore on Main Street. We worked all morning, but when we stepped back, the roof of the booth was crooked. "It looks like a cartoon house," Ava groaned. I was nervous that the owner would be upset, so I tried to explain what went wrong. Although she smiled, she said we would need to prove the booth was safe before the fair opened. We decided to compare our booth with a picture in an old building guide. The picture showed us that one of our posts was shorter than the other three. I grabbed a tool from the toolbox and fixed a wooden block under the short post. Ava hung a sign from a hook that said, "Choose a book, find a friend!" Then we checked the roof with a level, and the bubble sat right in the middle. That was all the proof the owner needed. By noon, kids were lined up to choose books from our not-so-crooked booth.

Questions

1. What is this story mostly about?

a) Two cousins argue about which book to read.
b) A bookstore closes for the fall.
c) Two cousins fix a crooked booth so it is ready for the fair.
d) Two cousins win a prize at the fair.

2. Why was the booth crooked at first?

a) The roof was too heavy.
b) One post was shorter than the other three.
c) The wind blew it over.
d) Ava sat on it.

3. How did the cousins probably feel when the bubble sat in the middle?

a) relieved and proud
b) angry
c) bored
d) scared

4. "Although she smiled, she said we would need to prove the booth was safe before the fair opened." What does prove mean?

a) to break into pieces
b) to paint brightly
c) to forget about
d) to show that something is true

5. Which sentence shows the owner was happy with the booth?

a) "It looks like a cartoon house," Ava groaned.
b) We decided to compare our booth with a picture in an old building guide.
c) That was all the proof the owner needed.
d) Every fall, our town holds a fair to celebrate the harvest.

6. What did the narrator do right after finding the short post?

a) hung a sign from a hook
b) fixed a wooden block under it
c) checked the roof with a level
d) went home for lunch

7. Why did the narrator try to explain what went wrong?

a) He was nervous the owner would be upset.
b) Ava told him to stop talking.
c) The fair was already over.
d) The owner was laughing at them.

Vocab builder: write what each word means, then use it in a sentence.

crooked: _____

explain: _____

although: _____

compare: _____

proof: _____

Why Flowers Bloom

(nonfiction)

In spring, many plants bloom, and their flowers open wide. A flower is not just pretty; it has an important job. Flowers make seeds so that new plants can grow. To make seeds, most flowers need pollen from another flower of the same kind. Bees, butterflies, and even some birds carry pollen as they move from bloom to bloom. Many flowers bloom only when the temperature and the amount of sunlight are just right. That is why tulips open in early spring, while sunflowers wait for the heat of summer. Some flowers even close at night and open again in the morning. Scientists observe flowers to learn how a changing environment affects them. When spring warms up early, some plants bloom before the bees are ready. Therefore, those flowers may not make as many seeds. You can help by planting flowers that bees like, such as clover or a butterfly bush. Even a small garden can feed a whole group of hungry insects.

Questions

1. What is this article mostly about?

a) How to pick flowers for a vase.
b) How bees make honey.
c) Why tulips are the best flower.
d) Flowers bloom to make seeds, and the timing matters.

2. What do most flowers need to make seeds?

a) extra salt in the soil
b) a lot of shade
c) pollen from another flower of the same kind
d) cold water every day

3. What might happen if the bees come out after the flowers are done blooming?

a) The flowers might make more seeds.
b) The flowers might make fewer seeds.
c) The bees might turn into butterflies.
d) The flowers might turn blue.

4. "Therefore, those flowers may not make as many seeds." What does therefore mean?

a) because of that
b) before that
c) maybe
d) never

5. Which sentence explains why different flowers bloom at different times?

a) A flower is not just pretty; it has an important job.
b) Even a small garden can feed a whole group of hungry insects.
c) Some flowers even close at night and open again in the morning.
d) Many flowers bloom only when the temperature and the amount of sunlight are just right.

6. Which flower opens first in the year?

a) sunflowers
b) clover
c) tulips
d) They all open on the same day.

7. What can cause some plants to bloom before the bees are ready?

a) too many bees
b) a spring that warms up early
c) planting clover
d) a very long night

Vocab builder: write what each word means, then use it in a sentence.

bloom: _____

pollen: _____

observe: _____

environment: _____

therefore: _____

Answer Key (for grown-ups)

The Crooked Booth

1. c) Two cousins fix a crooked booth so it is ready for the fair. [Main idea]
2. b) One post was shorter than the other three. [Details]
3. a) relieved and proud [Inference]
4. d) to show that something is true [Vocabulary in context]
5. c) That was all the proof the owner needed. [Evidence]
6. b) fixed a wooden block under it [Sequence]
7. a) He was nervous the owner would be upset. [Cause & effect]

Vocab: crooked = bent or not straight; explain = to tell how or why something happened; although = even though; compare = to look at how things are alike and different; proof = facts that show something is true

Why Flowers Bloom

1. d) Flowers bloom to make seeds, and the timing matters. [Main idea]
2. c) pollen from another flower of the same kind [Details]
3. b) The flowers might make fewer seeds. [Inference]
4. a) because of that [Vocabulary in context]
5. d) Many flowers bloom only when the temperature and the amount of sunlight are just right. [Evidence]
6. c) tulips [Sequence]
7. b) a spring that warms up early [Cause & effect]

Vocab: bloom = to open up into flowers; pollen = yellow dust that flowers need to make seeds; observe = to watch carefully; environment = the land, water, air, and weather around living things; therefore = because of that; so